AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER



The Bastion

Hardening & Defensive Infrastructure Tools

33	6	100%
FREE TOOLS	FLAGSHIP PICKS	FREE / OPEN

2026 Edition — every link re-verified 2026-10-15.
License-aware curation: copyleft, freemium and free-tier entries are tagged inline.
Part of **Awesome Cyber Security Heaven** — 438 curated tools across 14 realms.

ABOUT THIS REALM

The Bastion — Hardening & Defensive Infrastructure Tools

Lock it down before they get in — auditing, hardening and host/network defense tooling.

The mirror image of the Armory: what you install so you never get popped. Kernel-level audit, mandatory-access-control lineages (SELinux, OpenBSD PF), host hardening and firewall tooling — the unglamorous layer that stops real breaches.

- **Active in the last 30 days:** 19 of 28 tracked GitHub repos (68%)
- **Quiet classics (no push in 2+ years, still the standard):** GoPhish, Awesome WebSocket Security
- **Youngest entries:** Fail2ban (2011), OpenVPN (2012), ClamAV (2012)

THE COLLECTION

All 33 tools — with live facts

Every entry below was checked against the GitHub API on 2026-10-15: star counts, project ages, last-push dates and licenses are re-snapshotted on every monthly verification pass. Flagship picks carry the **FLAGSHIP** badge — the tools this realm is built around. Everything is free, free-tier or open source: no paywalls, no SaaS wrappers.

Fail2ban ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 18.8k · since 2011 · pushed 2026-10-10 · GPL-2.0

the classic log-watching IPS that bans brute-forcing IPs; still the default answer on every Linux server.

`github.com/fail2ban/fail2ban`

Lynis ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 16.5k | since 2013 | pushed 2026-09-16 | GPL-3.0

agentless system auditing and hardening with CIS/PCI-DSS-aligned findings; runs anywhere in minutes.

`github.com/CISOfy/lynis`

CrowdSec ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 15.2k | since 2020 | pushed 2026-10-15

collaborative behavior-detection engine with a global IP-reputation network; the modern Fail2ban, 60x faster and IPv6-ready.

`github.com/crowdsecurity/crowdsec`

OpenVPN ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 14.7k | since 2012 | pushed 2026-10-15 | GPL-2.0 core, component exceptions

the industry-standard open-source VPN daemon for site-to-site and remote-access tunnels.

`github.com/OpenVPN/openvpn`

GoPhish ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 14.3k | since 2013 | pushed 2024-09-23 ⏳

open-source phishing-simulation platform: launch awareness campaigns and measure exactly who clicks (community edition).

`github.com/gophish/gophish`

OpenSnitch ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 14.2k | since 2017 | pushed 2026-07-26 | GPL-3.0

interactive application firewall (Little Snitch for Linux): allow/deny every outbound connection per process.

`github.com/evilsocket/opensnitch`

Vuls

★ 12.3k | since 2016 | pushed 2026-10-15 | GPL-3.0

agentless vulnerability scanner for servers and containers, with CVE reporting across Linux and FreeBSD fleets.

`github.com/future-architect/vuls`

BunkerWeb

★ 11.1k · since 2019 · pushed 2026-10-15 · AGPL-3.0

next-gen open WAF built on nginx: HTTPS, bot mitigation and network protections on by default.

`github.com/bunkerity/bunkerweb`

testssl.sh

★ 9.2k · since 2014 · pushed 2026-10-07 · GPL-2.0

command-line TLS/SSL configuration auditor: protocols, ciphers, chains, vulnerabilities, grading — no agent required.

`github.com/drwetter/testssl.sh`

ClamAV

★ 7.4k · since 2012 · pushed 2026-08-27 · GPL-2.0

the open-source antivirus engine that powers mail gateways and file-screening pipelines everywhere.

`github.com/Cisco-Talos/clamav`

Fleet

★ 7.0k · since 2020 · pushed 2026-10-15 · MIT, open core

osquery fleet management: device visibility and policy enforcement at scale, open core with a free tier.

`github.com/fleetdm/fleet`

dev-sec hardening collection

★ 5.5k · since 2015 · pushed 2026-10-13

battle-tested Ansible roles for OS, SSH, nginx and MySQL baselines; hardening as code.

`github.com/dev-sec/ansible-collection-hardening`

OSSEC

★ 5.1k · since 2013 · pushed 2026-10-12 · GPL-2.0

the original open-source HIDS: log analysis, file integrity and rootkit detection (Wazuh's ancestor).

`github.com/ossec/ossec-hids`

OPNsense

★ 4.7k · since 2014 · pushed 2026-10-15 · BSD-2

open-source firewall/router distro with IDS, VPN and reporting — a pfSense successor built on HardenedBSD.

`github.com/opnsense/core`

ssh-audit

★ 4.3k · since 2017 · pushed 2026-10-11 · GPL-3.0

SSH server configuration auditor: algorithms, keys and best-practice flags in one run.

`github.com/jtesta/ssh-audit`

OpenSSH

★ 4.0k · since 2014 · pushed 2026-10-15 · BSD-style

the world's default secure remote-access suite: encrypted shells, tunnels and key management.

`github.com/openssh/openssh-portable`

Coraza

★ 3.9k · since 2020 · pushed 2026-10-15

ModSecurity-compatible WAF engine in Go; the actively developed successor for OWASP CRS deployments.

`github.com/corazawaf/coraza`

OWASP Core Rule Set

★ 3.3k · since 2020 · pushed 2026-10-15

the world's most-deployed WAF ruleset; battle-tested protection for web servers, tuned for ModSecurity and Coraza.

`github.com/coreruleset/coreruleset`

OpenRASP

★ 3.0k · since 2017 · pushed 2025-10-02 ⏳

runtime application self-protection: instrument the app itself so attacks get blocked from the inside.

`github.com/baidu/openrasp`

ComplianceAsCode content

★ 2.8k · since 2014 · pushed 2026-10-15

the open SCAP/Baseline rule corpus for RHEL, Ubuntu and friends; the content that powers OpenSCAP-style audits.

`github.com/ComplianceAsCode/content`

checksec.sh

★ 2.4k · since 2014 · pushed 2026-09-24 · BSD-3-Clause

one-shot binary hardening audit: NX, canaries, PIE, RELRO and fortify flags in a single run.

`github.com/slimm609/checksec.sh`

Neo23×0 auditd config

★ 2.0k · since 2018 · pushed 2026-05-04 · Apache-2.0

Florian Roth's hardened auditd rule set: the Linux logging baseline used across incident-response teams.

`github.com/Neo23x0/auditd`

open-appsec

★ 1.7k · since 2022 · pushed 2026-09-06

ML-driven prevention engine that stops OWASP Top 10 and zero-day web attacks without signatures.

`github.com/openappsec/openappsec`

SELinux

★ 1.6k · since 2014 · pushed 2026-10-14 · GPL-2.0

mandatory access control for Linux: policy-based confinement that survives a compromised application.

`github.com/SELinuxProject/selinux`

shellfirm

★ 946 · since 2021 · pushed 2026-05-15 · Apache-2.0

a pre-execution guard for your shell: challenges dangerous commands (rm -rf, kubectl delete) before they run.

`github.com/kaplanelad/shellfirm`

AIDE

★ 754 · since 2019 · pushed 2026-09-22 · GPL-2.0

Advanced Intrusion Detection Environment: file-integrity monitoring that alerts the moment system files change.

`github.com/aide/aide`

stunnel

★ 396 · since 2015 · pushed 2026-09-17 · GPL-2.0

universal TLS wrapper that adds encryption to any TCP service in minutes.

`github.com/mtrojnar/stunnel`

Awesome WebSocket Security

★ 315 · since 2021 · pushed 2022-01-10 ⏳ · Apache-2.0, curated list

curated research, tools and CVEs for WebSocket protocol security.

`github.com/PalindromeLabs/awesome-websocket-security`

Tor

BSD-3-Clause

the anonymity network: routed egress through thousands of volunteer relays; the standard for privacy-preserving research access.

`torproject.org/`

Netfilter/iptables

GPL-2.0

the Linux kernel's native packet-filtering framework; the foundation every host firewall build starts from.

`netfilter.org/`

OpenBSD PF

ISC

the packet filter famous for correctness and readable rules; the syntax OpenBSD, pfSense and OPNsense share.

`openbsd.org/faq/pf/`

SpamAssassin

Apache-2.0

the veteran open-source spam filter; bayesian scoring and rule engine at the mail gateway.

`spamassassin.apache.org/`

Qubes OS

GPL-2.0

the security-by-compartmentalization desktop OS; " reasonably secure" by architecture, not by antivirus.

`qubes-os.org/`



Keep this realm alive

Awesome Cyber Security Heaven is a hand-curated, license-verified map of 438 free cybersecurity tools across 14 realms — maintained, re-verified and free forever (CC0). Star the repo, propose a tool, or explore the other 13 realms.

Featured: 2MNY Website Vulnerability Scanner

200 free, self-hosted protection modules — SQLi, XSS, SSRF, subdomain takeover, CMS and AI-stack checks with evidence-backed, CVSS-scored reports. One Docker command, zero API keys.

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven
2mny.com

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